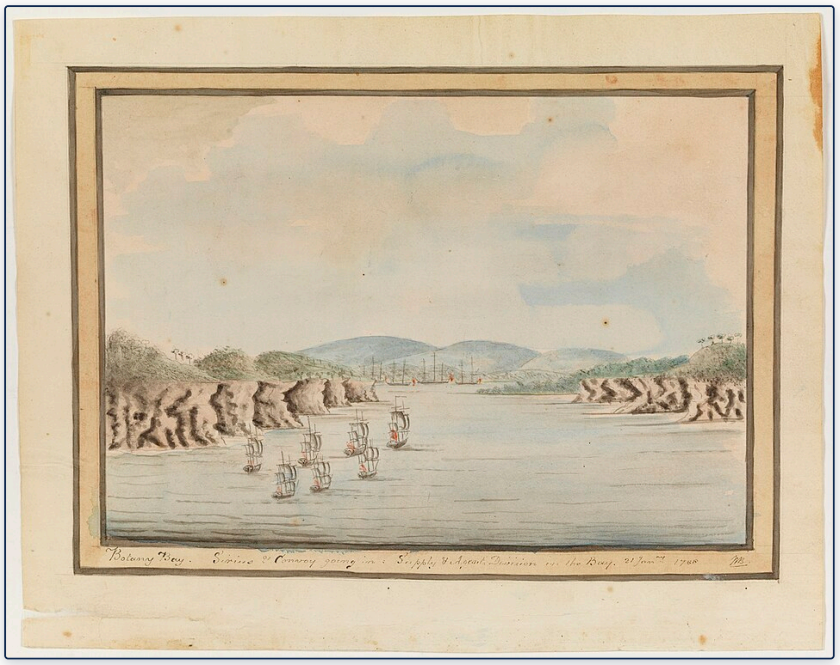
PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

YEAR 8 ENQUIRY • 1770–1901

The History of Australia (1770–1901)

First Nations Custodianship, Convict Colonisation, Frontier Wars & The Gold Rush



VISUAL DECODING • 4 CORE FEATURES

Francis Fowkes (1788)

In Jan 1788, eleven ships landed 1,400 convicts, marines, and sailors at Sydney Cove. Fowkes's survey records the vulnerable foothold of the penal colony:

1. DEEP-WATER ANCHORAGE: Transports ride at anchor in Sydney Cove after Phillip abandoned surf-swept Botany Bay.

2. CONVICT TENT CITY: Canvas tents and wattle huts house 750 prisoners battling scurvy and near-starvation.

3. FRESHWATER CREEK: The vital Tank Stream creek carved through sandstone to store drinking water.

4. INDIGENOUS ERASURE: Depicts empty land, erasing the sovereign presence of the Gadigal and Eora clans.

CANVAS TENTS Fragile foothold on an isolated continent.

NAVAL TRANSPORTS 15,000-mile exile under the Bloody Code.

EORA COUNTRY 65,000 years of custodianship erased.

DISCIPLINARY SIGNIFICANCE: In colonial history, surveying and cartography turned living Indigenous homelands into European property through the myth of *terra nullius*.

DISCIPLINARY HINGE QUESTION: EVALUATION

Does this contemporary survey depict the triumphant founding of a new nation, or the unauthorized military invasion of sovereign First Nations lands?

Primary Visual Evidence: *Sketch & Description of the Settlement at Sydney Cove* • Francis Fowkes (1788)

STATE LIBRARY OF NEW SOUTH WALES • SYDNEY

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: Captain Cook, Tupaia & Terra Nullius (1768–1770) *What is the significance of Captain Cook's voyage for the story of colonisation?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: The First Fleet & Convict Penal Colony (1783–1792) *Whose story do we tell about the founding of the first British penal colony in Australia?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: Frontier Warfare: Smallpox, Bennelong & Pemulwuy (1788–1802) *Was the colonisation of Australia a story of 'amity and kindness' or violent frontier resistance?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: The Frontier Wars, Pastoralism & The Black War (1803–1840) *How did pastoral expansion and frontier conflict transform colonial Australia?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The Gold Rush, Eureka Stockade & Legacy (1851–1901) *How did the 1851 Gold Rush and the Eureka Stockade transform Australian society and democracy?*	☐	☐

What is the significance of Captain Cook's voyage on the Endeavour in 1768 for the story of colonisation?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1768–1769 • Why did the British Admiralty issue secret imperial instructions to Captain Cook?

- Transit of Venus
- Secret Admiralty Orders
- Great Southern Land

2 1769–1770 • How did Tupaia's navigational mastery enable the Endeavour to reach New Zealand and Australia?

- 130 Pacific Islands
- Non-Instrument Navigation
- Indigenous Guidance

3 April 1770 • How did the Dharawal and Gweagal warriors defend their ancestral lands at Botany Bay?

- Two Gweagal Warriors
- Defensive Spear Protocol
- British Musket Fire

4 August 1770 • Why did Captain Cook claim eastern Australia on Possession Island without a treaty?

- Torres Strait Island
- Union Jack Flag
- New South Wales Claim

5 1770–1788 • How did the legal fiction of terra nullius justify British dispossession of First Nations peoples?

- European Property Law
- No Treaties Signed
- Two Centuries Dispossession

Polynesian navigator Tupaia could map 130 Pacific islands across 3,000 miles entirely from memory.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why the British Empire claimed eastern Australia and declared it terra nullius between 1768 and 1788. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Secret Admiralty instructions to locate the Great Southern Land** | **Joseph Banks's reports of Botany Bay and European property law**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

1. IMPERIAL RIVALRY	2. CARTOGRAPHY & SURVEYING	3. LEGAL DOCTRINE
Explain how competition with France and naval strategy drove the British Crown to seek Pacific territory.	Explain how maritime navigation, Indigenous guidance, and coastal charts identified Botany Bay.	Explain why British jurists dismissed Indigenous custodianship and classified the continent as nobody's land.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A primary reason for this development was that... • In particular, a decisive factor was... • Furthermore, strategic naval factors demonstrated that... • Crucially, an important legal justification occurred when... • Consequently, this resulted in...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Captain James Cook • Admiralty secret orders • Tupaia • Endeavour • Botany Bay • Gweagal clan • Possession Island • King George III • terra nullius • dispossession

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestones 1 & 2 (1770–1788): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 8–9). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out Cook & Tupaia's 1770 Botany Bay voyage, the 1788 First Fleet arrival at Sydney Cove, and the myth of *terra nullius*.

Whose story do we tell about the founding of the first British penal colony in Australia?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1783–1786 • Why did the loss of the American colonies force Britain to establish a penal colony in Australia?

- Loss of American Colonies
- Rotting Thames Hulks
- Typhus & Overcrowding

2 1787–1788 • How did Captain Arthur Phillip manage the 15,000-mile voyage of the First Fleet?

- 11 Sailing Ships
- 750 Convicts & 250 Marines
- 15,000 Miles via Cape Town

3 Jan 1788 • Why did Governor Phillip abandon Botany Bay and establish the settlement at Sydney Cove?

- Unprotected Botany Bay
- Port Jackson Deep Water
- Fresh Water Stream

4 1788–1790 • What factors pushed the early settlement at Sydney Cove to the brink of starvation?

- Sandy Unproductive Soil
- Broken Farming Hoes
- Shipwreck of HMS Guardian

5 1788–1792 • How did the system of convict labour balance severe punishment with the prospect of freedom?

- Dawn-to-Dusk Labour
- Cat-o'-Nine-Tails Lash
- 30-Acre Land Grants

Convict Mary Wade was sentenced to transportation at age 11 for stealing an 8-penny cotton frock.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of life on board the Thames prison hulks in the 1780s. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was… • Detail: Specifically, on board the hulks prisoners were… • Feature 2: A second key feature was… • Detail: This caused horrific suffering because…

Question 2: How Useful are Sources A and B [8 marks • 10 mins]

SOURCE UTILITY

How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the challenges faced by convicts and colonial authorities during the founding of Sydney Cove (1780–1792)? [8 marks]

Evaluate the evidential content, provenance (author, audience, motive), and historical context of both sources.

Analytical Connectives: *Source A is useful for investigating… because… • For instance, evidence indicates that… • However, its utility is limited by… • In contrast, Source B provides valuable evidence of… • Taken together, both sources…*
Key Terms: prison hulks • Bloody Code • First Fleet • Captain Arthur Phillip • Sydney Cove • starvation crisis • rations • emancipists

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 3 (1789): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 8–9). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out the 1789 *gal-galla* smallpox epidemic, 50–70% Eora mortality, and the loss of clan elders and law-keepers.

Was the colonisation of Australia a story of ‘amity and kindness’ or violent frontier resistance?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Pre-1788 • How did First Nations peoples manage and govern their lands before 1788?

- 250 Language Nations
- Fire-Stick Farming
- Songlines & Custodianship

2 April 1789 • What was the impact of the 1789 smallpox epidemic on the Eora people of Sydney?

- Gal-galla Smallpox
- 50–70% Eora Mortality
- Loss of Elders & Law

3 1789–1795 • Why did Bennelong act as a cultural intermediary between the British and the Eora?

- Kidnapped by Marines
- London Voyage 1793
- Trapped Between Two Worlds

4 1790–1797 • How did Pemulwuy lead Indigenous armed resistance against British expansion?

- Bidjigal Clan Leader
- Burning Settler Farms
- Battle of Parramatta (1797)

5 1795–1802 • Why did the Hawkesbury River expansion lead to protracted frontier warfare?

- Fertile Farming Invasions
- Shoot on Sight Orders
- Death of Pemulwuy (1802)

First Nations Australians have maintained continuous cultural custodianship of the continent for 65,000 years.

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

NARRATIVE ACCOUNT

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of Indigenous resistance and frontier conflict in New South Wales between 1788 and 1802. [8 marks]

Connectives: The sequence of conflict began when… • This produced devastating consequences because… • A major escalation occurred when… • Crucially, a decisive turning point took place when… • As a direct result…

Question 3: Explain the Importance [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORICAL IMPORTANCE

Explain the importance of Pemulwuy's guerrilla campaign (1790–1802) for Indigenous resistance against British colonisation. [8 marks]

Analytical Connectives: *The primary importance of this campaign was that… • In response to settler expansion, resistance leaders were able to… • Crucially, this had the effect of… • Consequently, it challenged imperial authority because…*
Key Terms: Pemulwuy • Bidjigal clan • guerrilla tactics • burning crops • Battle of Parramatta • Governor King • frontier warfare

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestone 4 (1797): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 8–9). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out Pemulwuy's Bidjigal guerrilla war, crop raids defending Country, and the 1797 Battle of Parramatta.

Exploration, Penal Invasion & Eora Resistance (1770–1797)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Causes & Context to the left • Events & Consequences to the right).

← POLYNESIAN NAVIGATION

1770 Cook, Tupaia & Terra Nullius (Enq 1)

BOTANY BAY & POSSESSION CLAIM →

← BRITISH PRISON HULKS

1788 First Fleet Lands at Sydney Cove (Enq 2)

750 CONVICTS & PENAL COLONY →

← ZERO VIRAL IMMUNITY

1789 Gal-galla Smallpox Outbreak (Enq 3)

50–70% EORA CLAN LOSS →

← SETTLER LAND SEIZURE

1797 Pemulwuy & Battle of Parramatta (Enq 3)

12-YEAR BIDJIGAL GUERRILLA WAR →

CONTINUE TO PART 2 (1828–1854) ON FACING PAGE ➔

Frontier Wars, Pastoral Expansion & Gold Democracy (1828–1854)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Pressures & Turning Points to the left • Outcomes & Legacy to the right).

← PASTORAL SHEEP BOOM

1828 Tasmanian Martial Law & Black Line (Enq 4)

1830 CORDON & DISPOSSESSION →

← 28 WIRRAYARAAY MURDERED

1838 Myall Creek Massacre & Trials (Enq 4)

7 STOCKMEN CONVICTED & HANGED →

← PAYABLE GOLD DISCOVERED

1851 Ballarat & Bendigo Gold Rush (Enq 5)

POPULATION TRIPLES TO 1.2M →

← CORRUPT LICENCE HUNTS

1854 Eureka Stockade Rebellion (Enq 5)

SOUTHERN CROSS & MALE VOTE →

SPINE COMPLETE (1770–1854) ➔

How did pastoral expansion and frontier conflict transform colonial Australia?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1803–1824 • Why did the British settlement of Van Diemen's Land trigger violent conflict with the Palawa people?

- Secondary Penal Colony
- Risdon Cove Cannon Fire
- Palawa Hunting Grounds

2 1826–1830 • How did Governor Arthur's martial law and the 'Black Line' escalate the Black War?

- Governor Arthur Martial Law
- 2,200 Armed Men
- The Black Line Sweeps

3 1830–1835 • Why was the relocation of the Palawa to Wybalenna on Flinders Island catastrophic?

- Truganini Peacemaking
- 200 Exiled to Flinders
- Wybalenna Camp Sickness

4 1820–1838 • How did the Merino wool boom drive violent frontier expansion across the Australian interior?

- Merino Sheep Flocks
- Yorkshire Wool Demand
- Seizing Native Waterholes

5 1838 • Why was the 1838 Myall Creek trial an unprecedented turning point in colonial Australian law?

- 28 Wirrayaraay Murdered
- 7 White Stockmen Hanged
- Squatter Outrage & Secrecy

The 1830 'Black Line' swept 2,200 armed men across Tasmania for seven weeks—and captured just two people.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • HISTORIAN HENRY REYNOLDS, THE OTHER SIDE OF THE FRONTIER (1981)

"The European occupation of Australia was resisted from the beginning by Indigenous peoples using guerrilla tactics. It was not a peaceful settlement, but a protracted, bloody war that cost the lives of at least 20,000 Aboriginal people defending their lands."

INTERPRETATION 2 • HISTORIAN KEITH WINDSCHUTTLE, THE FABRICATION OF ABORIGINAL HISTORY (2002)

"There was no systematic warfare or frontier genocide in colonial Australia. The conflicts that occurred were uncoordinated, small-scale criminal skirmishes over stolen goods and sheep, and the death tolls cited by orthodox historians have been drastically fabricated without documentary proof."

Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the nature and scale of frontier conflict in Australia. [4 marks] **PART B**

Sentence Stems: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on... • Interpretation 1 argues that... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 suggests that... • This is a difference because...

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on the reality of the Frontier Wars. [4 marks] **PART C**

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: One reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ is because they rely on different historical sources... • Specifically, Interpretation 1 uses... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses primarily on... • As a result, the authors reach different conclusions because...

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestones 5 & 6 (1828–1838): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 8–9). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out Tasmanian martial law & the 1830 Black Line alongside the 1838 Myall Creek Massacre and trials.

How did the 1851 Gold Rush and the Eureka Stockade transform Australian society and democracy?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1851–1853 • How did the 1851 gold discoveries transform Australia from a penal colony into an economic powerhouse?

- Hargraves 1851 Discovery
- Population Triples to 1.2m
- Melbourne Victorian Wealth

2 1853–1854 • Why did the monthly miner's licence fee provoke widespread outrage among the gold diggers?

- 30-Shilling Monthly Fee
- Armed Police Digger Hunts
- Taxation Without Representation

3 Dec 1854 • What was the significance of the 1854 Eureka Stockade for the development of Australian democracy?

- Southern Cross Flag
- 15-Minute Dawn Assault
- Secret Ballot & Universal Suffrage

4 1855–1901 • How did anti-Chinese hostility on the goldfields lead directly to the 1901 White Australia Policy?

- 40,000 Chinese Diggers
- Lambing Flat Riots (1861)
- 1901 Immigration Restriction Act

5 1901–Present • How did the 1938 Day of Mourning and the 1992 Mabo Decision reshape modern Australian history?

- 1938 Day of Mourning
- Stolen Generations Truth
- 1992 Mabo Overturns Terra Nullius

The Southern Cross flag was sewn from silk petticoats by women on the Ballarat goldfield in 1854.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

'The discovery of gold and the Eureka Stockade were the most important turning points in 19th-century Australian history.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The 1851 Gold Rush and the Eureka Stockade rebellion (1854)**

Pastoral expansion, the wool boom, and the frontier wars (1820–1840)

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

1. GOLD RUSH & DEMOCRACY	2. PASTORAL DISPOSSESSION	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Explain how the influx of immigrants, economic wealth, and digger rebellion fostered democratic rights.	Explain how the wool boom drove violent territorial conquest and the dispossession of First Nations peoples.	Weigh which development had a more enduring structural and human impact on the shaping of Australia.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A compelling argument supporting this statement is that... • In particular, demographic and democratic changes were decisive because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • Crucially, frontier and economic evidence demonstrates that... • In conclusion, the more significant development was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Edward Hargraves • Ballarat • 30-shilling licence • Southern Cross flag • Peter Lalor • manhood suffrage • squatter pastoralists • Merino wool • Myall Creek • terra nullius • First Nations survival

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Milestones 7 & 8 (1851–1854): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 8–9). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out the 1851 Ballarat gold rush, the 30-shilling licence tax, and the 1854 Eureka Stockade democratic uprising.

NOTES • REVISION & ASSESSMENT PLANNING

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

NOTES • REVISION & ASSESSMENT PLANNING

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET KS3 LEVEL:** _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA

YEARS 7–9 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–5)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Identifies key names, dates, and terms; describes what happened using simple statements and structured writing frames.	Describes reasons why events occurred; begins to explain causes and consequences supported by basic historical facts.	Constructs structured paragraphs explaining multiple causes and consequences; substantiates arguments with precise historical dates, key terms, and named figures.	Weighs competing factors and perspectives; explains why certain causes were more decisive than others using detailed, accurate evidence across the unit.	Crafts sustained, analytically rigorous arguments reaching a substantiated historical judgement; masterfully synthesizes evidence across the unit to evaluate complex turning points and long-term significance.

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	DO NOW (/5)	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: Cook, Tupaia & Terra Nullius Causal Explanation: Pacific Claims & Terra Nullius (1768–1788)	/ 5		
	Enquiry 2: The First Fleet & Penal Colony Feature Drill & Source Utility: Hulks & Sydney Settlement	/ 5		
	Enquiry 3: Frontier Warfare & Pemulwuy Narrative Account & Importance: Sydney Frontier Resistance	/ 5		
	Enquiry 4: Pastoralism & The Black War Contrasting Interpretations: Reynolds vs Windschuttle	/ 5		
	Enquiry 5: Gold Rush & Eureka Stockade Evaluative Judgement: Turning Points in Australian History	/ 5		
	Independent Study & Notes Portfolio Pages 14–15 Enquiry Notes, Reflection & Revision Tasks	—		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task	—		
★	**UNIT RETRIEVAL STARTER TOTAL:**	/ 25	Overall Retrieval Grade: [Emerging • Expected • Greater Depth]	

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
Cook & Terra Nullius	First Fleet & Hulks	Pemulwuy & Frontier	Pastoralism & Black War	Eureka & Democracy
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]

From Botany Bay to Eureka, colonisation in Australia was marked by First Nations resistance and the struggle for freedom.